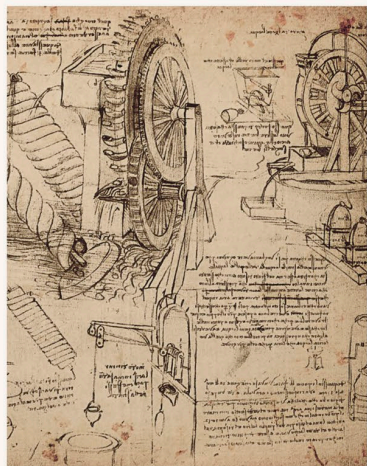


approach would seem more trouble than it was worth—but not to Leonardo.

Leonardo's notebooks mixed words, drawings, geometry—whatever came into his head. Leonardo may have written his notebooks with the intention of having them published at some point. He taught himself Latin, thinking that he could write up his findings. Any serious academic publication had to be written in Latin at this time, as it was the language of the educated elite.



This is Leonardo's design for a "perpetual-motion" machine. The idea was that the constantly spinning wheel created energy.

WHAT IS MIRROR WRITING?

Mirror writing is a technique in which a person writes from right to left, instead of from left to right. For Western languages, such as Italian and English, this is the opposite of the normal way of writing. When viewed in a mirror, the reflection reverses the letters so that the text can be read in the usual way, left to right.